



Rules

To participate in the challenge, please carefully review and comply with the following rules and requirements.

1. Challenge Structure

The competition includes one mandatory challenge and three optional challenges:

- **Mandatory Challenge – Dengue (State Level):** Forecast dengue cases at the state (UF) level for all Brazilian states, except Espírito Santo.
 - **Optional Challenge 1 – Dengue (City Level):** Forecast dengue cases for 15 selected cities.
 - **Optional Challenge 2 – Chikungunya (State Level):** Forecast chikungunya cases at the state (UF) level for all Brazilian states, except Espírito Santo.
 - **Optional Challenge 3 – Chikungunya (City Level):** Forecast chikungunya cases for 10 selected cities.
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2. Model Requirements

- Your model must be hosted in a **public repository** on GitHub or GitLab.
- The model must be registered on the Mosqlimate platform and named according to the following pattern:
`3rd_imdc_{institution}_{team_name}`
 - All characters must be lowercase.
 - `institution` must correspond to the acronym of the team leader's institution.
 - In `team_name`, you may choose any name you like, but it must contain only lowercase letters.
- The repository must include a **well-documented README** to ensure reproducibility. The README must contain the following sections:
 1. Team and Contributors
 2. Repository Structure
 3. Libraries and Dependencies
 4. Data and Variables
 5. Model Training
 6. Data Usage Restriction
 7. Predictive Uncertainty

8. References

- You may submit more than one model. However, **each submitted model must include predictions for all targets within the challenge(s)** it is intended to participate in.

Additional details on how to complete the README and submit your model are available in the [official template](#).

3. Data Usage Policy

- Any dataset **not available via the FTP server or the Mosqlimate API** must be submitted to the organizers.
 - These datasets will be shared with all participants to ensure fairness and reproducibility.
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4. Prediction Format and Requirements

4.1 Prediction Data Structure

Your prediction dataframe must include the following columns:

- **date:** Forecast target date (format: YYYY-MM-DD).
- **pred:** Median prediction (50th percentile).
- **lower_x and upper_x:** Prediction intervals of 50%, 80%, 90% and 95%. For example:
 - lower_95 (2.5th percentile)
 - upper_95 (97.5th percentile)These define a 95% prediction interval.

4.2 Validation Rules

To be accepted by the platform, predictions must strictly follow these rules:

- **Sunday dates:** All prediction dates must fall on Sundays (weekly resolution).
- **Continuous dates:** No gaps are allowed in the sequence of dates.
- **Challenge timeframe:** Predictions must cover all dates between Epidemiological Week (EW) 41 of the previous year and EW 40 of the target year.
- **Positive values:** All predictions must be greater than or equal to zero.
- **Nested intervals:** Prediction intervals must follow a consistent order:
$$\text{lower_95} \leq \text{lower_90} \leq \text{lower_80} \leq \text{lower_50} \leq \text{pred} \leq \text{upper_50} \leq \text{upper_80} \leq \text{upper_90} \leq \text{upper_95}$$

Additional details on how to submit your predictions are available in the [official template](#).

5. Submission Timeline and Forecast Targets

For each geographic unit (state or city, depending on the challenge), the following predictions must be submitted:

5.1 Validation Phase (Deadline: July 1)

- **Validation Test 1:**

Forecast weekly cases for the 2022–2023 season (EW41 2022 – EW40 2023), using data from EW01 2010 to EW25 2022.

- **Validation Test 2:**

Forecast weekly cases for the 2023–2024 season (EW41 2023 – EW40 2024), using data from EW01 2010 to EW25 2023.

- **Validation Test 3:**

Forecast weekly cases for the 2024–2025 season (EW41 2024 – EW40 2025), using data from EW01 2010 to EW25 2024.

- **Validation Test 4:**

Forecast weekly cases for the 2025–2026 season (EW41 2025 – EW40 2026), using data from EW01 2010 to EW25 2025.

5.2 Forecast Phase

(After data update on July 31, deadline: September 10)

- **Forecast Target:**

Predict weekly dengue cases for the 2026–2027 season (EW41 2026 – EW40 2027), using all available data from EW01 2010 to EW25 2026.

6. Submission Completeness

- It is **mandatory** to submit both validation and forecast sets.
 - Submissions must include predictions for **all geographic units** within each selected challenge.
 - **Incomplete submissions** (missing geographic units or required prediction sets) will **not be considered** in the final evaluation.
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7. Evaluation and Compliance

If any issues are identified in the model methodology or submitted predictions:

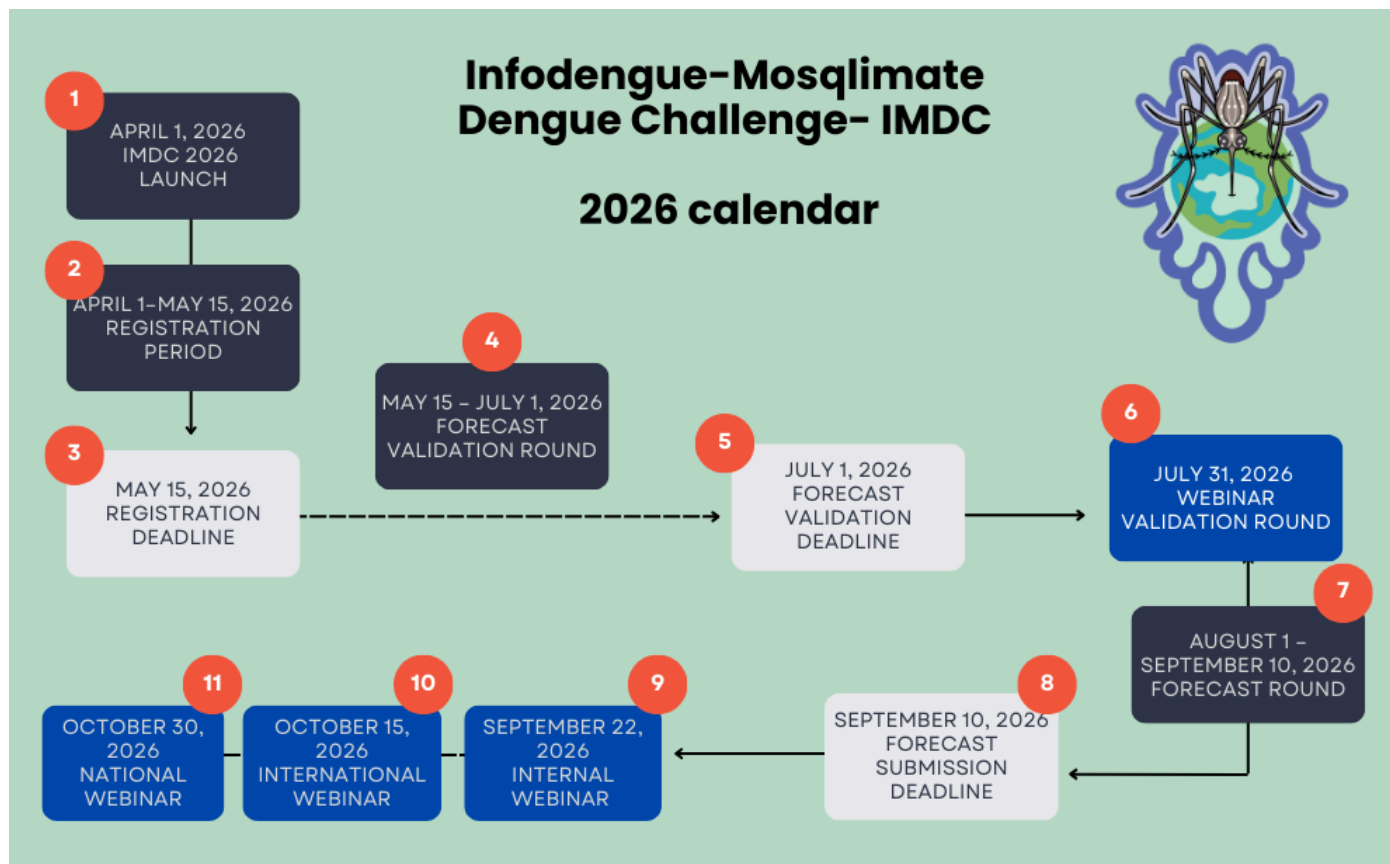
- The authors will be contacted and given the opportunity to make corrections.
 - However, the organizers reserve the **full right to exclude the model** from the final reports submitted to the Ministry of Health if issues are not adequately resolved.
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Please ensure full compliance with these guidelines to guarantee that your submission is valid and considered for evaluation. **For further details, please refer to the [Instructions tab](#).**

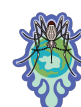
Important dates:

- **April 1, 2026** – Challenge launch and opening of team registrations

- **May 15, 2026** – Deadline for team registration
- **July 1, 2026** – Submission deadline for validation round results
- **July 31, 2026** – Webinar: Presentation of validation round results
- **September 10, 2026** – Submission deadline for 2026–2027 forecasts
- **September 22, 2026** – Internal webinar for teams to present model methodologies
- **October 15, 2026** – International webinar: Technical results of IMDC 2026
- **October 30, 2026** – International webinar: IMDC 2026 results for the general audience



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**INFO
DENGUE**